

Holiday Allowance (Vakantiegeld) — Netherlands

Guide for payroll consultants handling Dutch employment contracts

Country	Netherlands (NL)	Applies to	All NL clients
Product	Payroll	Effective from	1 June 2025
Owner	Payroll Expertise Centre NL	Next review	June 2026

Scope. This guide applies to Dutch employment contracts only. Belgian holiday pay (enkel/dubbel vakantiegeld) follows completely different rules — see PAY-BE-PRC-014.

1. Statutory rule

Every employee in the Netherlands is entitled to a holiday allowance of at least **8% of gross annual salary** (Wet minimumloon en minimumvakantiebijslag). A collective labour agreement (CAO) or the employment contract may grant more, never less.

2. Accrual and payment

- The allowance accrues over the reference period **1 June to 31 May**.
- It is paid out **once a year, in May or June**, unless the contract provides for monthly payment.
- On termination, the accrued but unpaid allowance is paid with the final salary.

3. Basis

Element	Included in basis?	Remarks
Fixed monthly salary	Yes	
Structural overtime	Yes	If agreed in contract or CAO
Incidental overtime	No	Unless the CAO says otherwise
Bonus / 13th month	No	Unless the CAO says otherwise
Salary above 3× minimum wage	Optional	Employer may cap the basis

4. Example

An employee earns € 4,000 gross per month. Annual basis: $12 \times € 4,000 = € 48,000$. Holiday allowance: $€ 48,000 \times 8\% = € 3,840$, paid in May.